

Southern skies

If you live south of the equator, you live in the southern hemisphere. On a clear night, the southern skies give a fantastic view of the Milky Way, bright star clusters, constellations, colourful nebulae – and even whole galaxies.

OMEGA CENTAURI IS THE LARGEST STAR CLUSTER IN OUR GALAXY, CONTAINING AROUND TEN MILLION STARS

KEY

This map shows stars that are visible to the naked eye. Magnitude marks how bright a star is – the lower the number, the brighter the star.

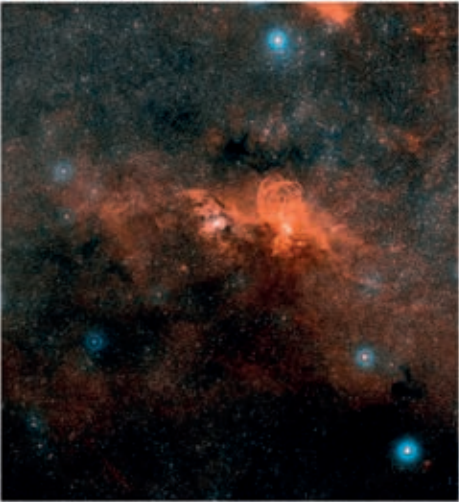
- Yellow star
- Red star
- Orange star
- White star
- Blue star

- Magnitude brighter than 0.0
- Magnitude brighter than 1.0
- Magnitude brighter than 2.0

- Magnitude brighter than 3.0
- Magnitude brighter than 4.0
- Magnitude brighter than 5.0

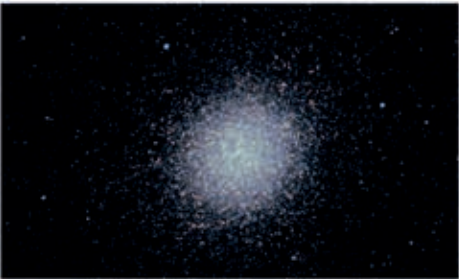
THINGS TO LOOK FOR

The southern skies contain many night-sky objects that are not visible from the northern hemisphere, including the Magellanic clouds and the bright star cluster known as the Jewel Box.



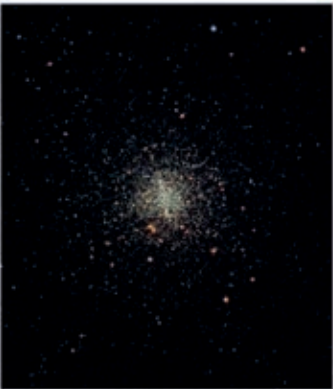
NGC 3603 NEBULA

This giant nebula in the constellation Carina is composed of huge glowing clouds of gas. In its centre are thousands of hot, young stars.



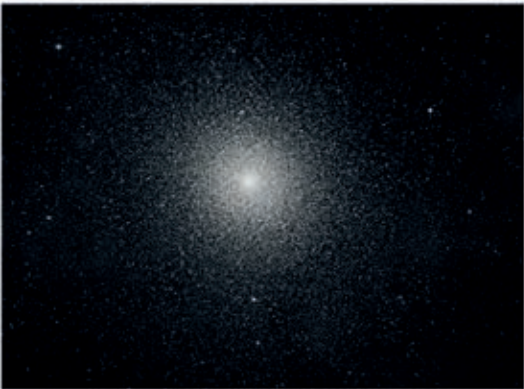
OMEGA CENTAURI CLUSTER

This is the largest and brightest globular cluster visible from Earth – it appears as a fuzzy star to the naked eye. It is in the centre of the Centaurus constellation.



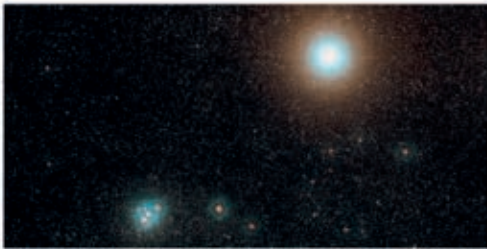
M4 GLOBULAR CLUSTER

This cluster is around 12.2 billion years old. It is found near the bright star Antares, in the constellation Scorpius.



47 TUCANAEE GLOBULAR CLUSTER

This huge star cluster is around 16,700 light years from Earth, in the constellation of Tucana. It contains several million stars but looks like a single hazy star to the naked eye.



THE JEWEL BOX CLUSTER

Shown at the bottom left here, this cluster includes a red supergiant and smaller blue stars. It is in the constellation Crux. The bright star in the upper right here is called Mimosa.



LARGE MAGELLANIC CLOUD

This small galaxy orbits our own galaxy, the Milky Way. It sits in the constellation Dorado, though part of it is in the constellation Mensa.



ROSETTE NEBULA

This flower-shaped nebula is a star nursery – stars are being created within it – and there is a cluster of new stars at its centre. It can be seen with a small telescope in the constellation Monoceros.



CORVUS CONSTELLATION

Corvus, the crow, is made up of four bright stars, shown in the lower-right half of this image. It sits close to the very bright double star known as Spica (top left).

